

Great books

Thousands of years ago, stories were simply spoken aloud or told with pictures. As writing developed, tales were inscribed on stone, and then on parchment and paper. Great books transport us to different lives and are enjoyed by generations of readers all over the world.

► 2ND MILLENNIUM BCE

THE EPIC OF GILGAMESH

This poem was inscribed on clay tablets and is thought to be the first piece of written literature. It describes the journey of Gilgamesh, king of Uruk, who is on a quest with a wild man to fight evil.

“Humbaba’s mouth is fire; his roar the floodwater; his breath is death.”

► c.16TH-1ST CENTURY BCE

THE EGYPTIAN BOOK OF THE DEAD

This collection of drawings and magic spells was written over hundreds of years in Ancient Egypt. The spells were buried with the dead to help them in their next life in the Underworld.

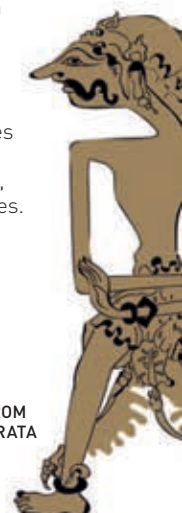


A PAGE FROM THE BOOK OF THE DEAD

► c.4TH-2ND CENTURY BCE

INDIAN EPICS

Mahabharata by Vyasa and *Ramayana* by Valmiki are important Sanskrit poems that began as spoken songs. They tell stories about Indian culture, Hinduism, great wars, and exciting adventures.



A WARRIOR FROM THE MAHABHARATA

◀ 1908

ANNE OF GREEN GABLES

L M Montgomery tells a heart-warming tale about an orphan with a wonderful imagination. Anne is sent to a family who asked for a boy, but she thrives in her new home.

“Because when you are imagining you might as well imagine something worthwhile.”

◀ 1894

SEVEN LITTLE AUSTRALIANS

This delightful story by Ethel Turner is about the mischievous Woolcot children, running wild at their home in Sydney.



BABY WOOLCOT WASHES THE KITTENS

◀ 1876



TOM SAWYER

THE ADVENTURES OF TOM SAWYER

Wily Tom Sawyer plays tricks on everyone but after he witnesses a murder, the games get serious. Mark Twain’s adventures include graverobbers, children lost in caves, and a box of gold.

◀ 1861

GREAT EXPECTATIONS

Charles Dickens’s story about Pip on his journey to becoming a gentleman includes bitter old Miss Havisham. She has been wearing her wedding gown ever since she was jilted at the altar.

“Ask no questions and you’ll be told no lies.”

◀ 1847

JANE EYRE

In Charlotte Brontë’s novel, Jane Eyre has a harsh upbringing as an orphan. When she becomes a governess, she falls in love with her employer, Mr Rochester, who has a terrible secret in his house.

“I am no bird; and no net ensnares me.”

► 1935

► 1937

► 1937

► 1943

► 1945

► 1947



THE PENGUIN LOGO

PENGUIN PAPERBACKS

Most quality books were published with expensive hard covers until Allen Lane created Penguin paperbacks. He wanted people everywhere to be able to read good books in a format that they could afford.

OF MICE AND MEN

John Steinbeck tells a sad, bleak story about two farmhands struggling to find work during the Depression in the USA. George tries to look out for his strong, slow-witted friend Lennie who dreams of farming rabbits.



LENNIE’S MOUSE

THE HOBBIT

For this story, J R R Tolkien created a complete world called Middle Earth filled with hobbits, wizards, elves, dwarves, and trolls. On his quest to steal a dragon’s treasure, Bilbo Baggins meets many dangers and finds a powerful magic ring.



THE RING



THE LITTLE PRINCE’S HOME PLANET

THE LITTLE PRINCE

This magical little story from Antoine de Saint-Exupéry tells the tale of a pilot who is stranded in the desert. He comes across a little prince, who has fallen to Earth from another planet.

ANIMAL FARM

George Orwell was making a political point with this story about animals taking over a farm to create an equal society. Things go badly wrong after Napoleon the pig seizes power.



NAPOLEON THE PIG

THE DIARY OF A YOUNG GIRL

Anne Frank was 13 when she and her family went into hiding from the Nazis in World War II. The diary she wrote in their secret rooms has been translated into 70 languages.



ANNE FRANK’S DIARY